

PROGRAMMING LANGUAGE POPULARITY REPORT

TIOBE Index March 2026: How 20+ Search Engines Rank the World's Programming Languages

26

Ratings are calculated from web-page hit counts across Google, Bing, Wikipedia, Amazon, and 20+ other sites — measuring how much each language is discussed and sought after globally, updated monthly since 2001.

21.25%

PYTHON #1 RATING

~49%

TOP 4 COMBINED

50+

LANGUAGES TRACKED

Source: tiobe.com/tiobe-index
Captured April 10, 2026

Python Holds #1 at 21.25% but C Surges to #2 with the Largest Gain

▲ RISING

▼ FALLING

— FLAT

#	LANGUAGE	↑↓	PREV	RATING	YOY
1	Python	—	1	21.25%	-2.59%
2	C	▲	4	11.55%	+2.02%
3	C++	▼	2	8.18%	-2.90%
4	Java	▼	3	7.99%	-2.37%
5	C#	—	5	6.36%	+1.49%
6	JavaScript	—	6	3.45%	-0.01%
7	Visual Basic	▲	9	2.50%	-0.02%
8	SQL	—	8	2.00%	-0.57%
9	R	▲	16	1.88%	+0.94%
10	Delphi/Object Pascal	—	10	1.80%	-0.36%
11	Perl	▲	24	1.75%	+1.05%
12	Scratch	—	12	1.63%	-0.03%
13	Fortran	▼	11	1.45%	-0.25%
14	Rust	—	14	1.31%	+0.09%
15	MATLAB	—	15	1.29%	+0.31%
16	Go	▼	7	1.29%	-1.49%
17	Assembly	—	17	1.29%	+0.42%
18	PHP	▼	13	1.23%	-0.25%
19	Ada	▼	18	1.10%	+0.25%
20	Swift	▲	26	1.04%	+0.44%



Perl Jumps 13 Spots, R Climbs 7, and Go Drops 9 — The Biggest Rank Shifts of 2026

▲ GAINERS MAR 2025 → MAR 2026

+13	Perl	24th → 11th	+1.85%
-----	------	-------------	--------

▼ LOSERS MAR 2025 → MAR 2026

-9	Go	7th → 16th	-1.49%
----	----	------------	--------

From Lisp at #2 in 1986 to Python at #1 in 2026: How Rankings Shifted Over Four Decades

Python — Meteoric Rise

C — Permanent Fixture

Java — Long Decline

JavaScript — Web Giant, Index Outlier



Python Wins Language of the Year 6 Times — More Than Any Other Language

WINNERS 2016-2025

2025	C#	C#
2024	Python	6x

6x

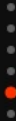
PYTHON WINS — MORE THAN ANY LANGUAGE

Wins in 2007, 2010, 2018, 2020, 2021, 2024. Reflects Python's sustained momentum across ML, data science, scripting, and automation.

C# — Back-to-Back 2023 & 2025

The .NET ecosystem's continued growth drives C# to its second consecutive two-year run of the award, suggesting genuine enterprise adoption momentum.

Python also won in 2007, 2010. Total: 6 wins.



The Top 4 Languages Hold 49% of the Index: What This Means for Your Tech Stack

01 - Python

21.25%

Dominant but Declining — Watch the Trajectory

Python leads by a wide margin but posts the largest rating drop among the top 5 (-2.59pp). Still the safe bet for ML and data teams, but monitor momentum shifts annually.

02 - C & Legacy Languages

+2.02pp

C Surges; Perl, R, Fortran Stay Relevant

C gained more than any top-5 language. Perl jumped 13 spots, R jumped 7. Infrastructure, scientific computing, and systems workloads still demand these languages — don't phase them out prematurely.

03 - Go & Mobile

-9 Ranks

Go's Sharpest Drop; Kotlin Exits Top 20

Go fell from 7th to 16th — the largest absolute drop in the top 20. Possible displacement by Rust (14th, +0.09%). Kotlin dropped to 22nd while Swift re-entered at 20th. Cross-platform frameworks may be a factor.

